

Got it — thanks for explaining clearly!

You are saying:

- **Main Website** → `cuk.ac.in` (already deployed, static site, running fine on Plesk).
- **Your New App** → A **full stack** (React + Node.js + MySQL) **IQAC** app.
- **Requirement** → This IQAC app should appear as part of the main website, like under a subpath (e.g., `cuk.ac.in/iqac`).

So, the goal is:

- ☒ `cuk.ac.in` → your existing static site (no change).
- ☒ `cuk.ac.in/iqac` → should load your new React + Node.js app frontend.
- ☒ `cuk.ac.in/api` (or something similar) → should internally handle backend API calls for the IQAC app.

Here's the **correct deployment plan for your case**:

1. Structure inside Plesk

You should **NOT disturb** the main site's `httpdocs`.

Instead, inside `/httpdocs`, you can organize:

```
/httpdocs/  
  index.html    (your main site)  
  /iqac/        (your React build)  
  /iqac-api/    (your Node.js backend files)
```

2. Deploy IQAC React Frontend

Locally on your machine:

```
cd iqac-frontend  
npm run build
```

- This generates a `build/` folder.

Then:

- In Plesk, create a **new folder inside** `httpdocs` called `/iqac`.
- Upload everything from the **build folder** into `/httpdocs/iqac/`.

Now, when someone visits:

```
https://cuk.ac.in/iqac/
```

they'll see your **React frontend**!

3. Deploy IQAC Node.js Backend

- In Plesk, create another folder `/httpdocs/iqac-api`.
- Upload your backend project files into `/iqac-api`.
- In Plesk, **activate Node.js** for `/iqac-api/`:
 - Set **Document Root**: `/httpdocs/iqac-api`
 - Set **Application Startup File**: `server.js` or `app.js`
- Open Terminal and run:

```
cd /httpdocs/iqac-api
npm install
```

Make sure your backend runs on an internal port (e.g., `localhost:3000`).

4. Connect Frontend to Backend

In your **React frontend** `.env.production` file:

```
REACT_APP_API_URL=https://cuk.ac.in/iqac-api
```

(or set it directly in Axios/fetch API base URL if you are not using `.env`).

5. Configure Nginx or Apache Reverse Proxy (for Backend API)

You need to make `/iqac-api` a **reverse proxy** to Node.js app.

In Plesk:

- Go to **Domains > cuk.ac.in > Apache & nginx Settings**.
- Under **Additional Nginx Directives**, add:

```
location /iqac-api/ {
    proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:3000/; # assuming your Node.js app runs on 3000
    proxy_http_version 1.1;
    proxy_set_header Upgrade $http_upgrade;
    proxy_set_header Connection 'upgrade';
    proxy_set_header Host $host;
    proxy_cache_bypass $http_upgrade;
}
```

☒ This way, **cuk.ac.in/iqac-api** will forward requests to your running Node.js backend.

6. Database (MySQL)

- Already setup via Plesk (phpMyAdmin)?
- Update backend **.env** for database access (**localhost**, db username, password).

Example:

```
DB_HOST=localhost
DB_USER=iqac_user
DB_PASS=yourpassword
DB_NAME=iqac_db
```

7. SSL (HTTPS)

Because **cuk.ac.in** already has SSL, **your /iqac and /iqac-api are automatically HTTPS secured.**

No extra SSL steps needed.

 Final URL structure:

URL	Purpose
https://cuk.ac.in	Main University Website
https://cuk.ac.in/iqac/	IQAC React Frontend
https://cuk.ac.in/iqac-api/your-api-route	IQAC Node.js Backend API

 Important Tips:

- Make sure **homepage** in React **package.json** is **/iqac/** before building:

```
"homepage": "/iqac/"
```

- Use **relative paths** (**/iqac/xyz**) inside React routes.
 - Test **local API URLs** carefully with **/iqac-api** prefix.
 - Restart Node.js app in Plesk after changes.
-

Perfect! 

Here's a **complete deployment blueprint** for you:
(You can **directly follow and paste** wherever needed.)

Folder Structure in `/httpdocs/`

```
/httpdocs/
|- index.html          (Main website - already running)
|- css/                (Main website assets)
|- js/                 (Main website assets)
|- iqac/               (React app build files)
  |- index.html
  |- static/
  |- asset-manifest.json
  |- ...
|- iqac-api/           (Node.js backend)
  |- server.js
  |- package.json
  |- routes/
  |- controllers/
  |- .env
  |- ...
```

- ☒ This way, **main website** remains safe.
 - ☒ IQAC frontend lives at `/iqac/`, backend lives at `/iqac-api/`.
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nginx Settings (Paste inside "Additional nginx directives" in Plesk)

Go to

-  **Domains > cuk.ac.in > Apache & nginx Settings**
-  **Additional nginx directives**

Paste **this**:

```
# Serve the IQAC React frontend
location /iqac/ {
    root /var/www/vhosts/cuk.ac.in/httpdocs/;
    index index.html;
    try_files $uri $uri/ /iqac/index.html;
}

# Proxy IQAC Backend API to Node.js server
location /iqac-api/ {
    proxy_pass http://127.0.0.1:3000/; # If your Node.js app listens on port 3000
```

```
proxy_http_version 1.1;
proxy_set_header Upgrade $http_upgrade;
proxy_set_header Connection 'upgrade';
proxy_set_header Host $host;
proxy_cache_bypass $http_upgrade;
}
```

🔒 **Remember:** adjust the `proxy_pass` if your backend uses another port.

React Frontend Settings

In your React app:

- Set `homepage` in `package.json` **before building**:

```
"homepage": "/iqac/"
```

- Update your `.env.production` (or manually in your frontend code):

```
REACT_APP_API_URL=https://cuk.ac.in/iqac-api
```

Then build again:

```
npm run build
```

and upload the fresh `build/` output into `/httpdocs/iqac/`.

Backend Node.js Settings

In your `server.js` or `app.js`, make sure your backend expects **API under `/iqac-api`**, like:

```
app.use('/iqac-api', yourRouter);
```

OR adjust your routes carefully if you are mounting `/`.

- ☒ Your `.env` file for backend:

```
PORT=3000
DB_HOST=localhost
DB_USER=your_mysql_user
DB_PASSWORD=your_mysql_password
DB_NAME=your_db_name
```

☒ Install dependencies:

```
npm install
```

☒ Start App from Plesk Node.js panel (or manually restart).

☒ Final Behavior After This Setup

What	URL	Notes
Main Website	https://cuk.ac.in	Static website, untouched.
IQAC App Frontend	https://cuk.ac.in/iqac/	React app runs here.
IQAC App API	https://cuk.ac.in/iqac-api/	API routes handled by Node.js server.

Quick Pro Tips:

- Always run `npm run build` **AFTER** updating `homepage` in `package.json`.
 - Use relative paths in React Router:
If using React Router, set `basename="/iqac"` in your `BrowserRouter`.
 - Restart Node.js app after changes.
 - If backend is failing, check logs in Plesk (**Logs** tab).
 - Make sure **port 3000** is open internally on the server (Plesk handles it usually).
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